



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Tri-Cities Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.lcstn.org/tca/home>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Tri-Cities Christian Academy (TCA) in Blountville, TN, operating within the Lakeway Christian Schools system, demonstrates substantive alignment with classical education in several of the Six Essential Elements rubric's categories, particularly Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The school presents a robust Christ-centered, biblically integrated program, a formation-oriented mission, and a parental-partner model. Its curriculum includes biblical integration across subjects and some classical elements (e.g., Latin offerings; structured history sequencing), but it does not consistently foreground explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, or a full Seven Liberal Arts framework. Pedagogy and contemplative practices are mentioned in the broader classical lexicon, yet explicit Socratic seminars, scholé days, or a formal articulation of grammar–logic–rhetoric within a classical pedagogy are not consistently documented in public materials. The faculty portrayal emphasizes challenging, yet supportive teaching, and there is strong evidence of parent involvement and community partnership.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

Key insights:

- Strong religious/metaphysical grounding: chapel, biblical worldview, statements of faith, Christ-centered education.
- Formation-focused purpose: emphasis on wisdom, character, virtue, and leadership aligned with a biblical telos.
- Curriculum includes biblical integration and classical touchpoints (Latin, historiography sequencing); not explicit Great Books or universal "Great Conversation."
- Pedagogy lacks explicit, public, high-fidelity articulation of Socratic seminars or scholé-based daily rhythm in the public materials, though there is evidence of a value system that prizes deep thinking and memory work in other classical sources.
- Faculty is portrayed as a living curriculum with intentional formation; parents and community are deeply engaged as co-educators and partners.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes Christ-centered, biblically grounded education, with statements like "Christ-centered education," "biblical worldview," and "Statement of Faith." Public materials describe a Christ-centered environment and biblical integration across coursework (e.g., "Biblical Truth is the foundation of our faith and our school" and "Biblical integration into each subject while... growth potential"). Chapel and worship are activities embedded in the weekly schedule.
- Mission and vision explicitly tie education to spiritual formation and leadership for Christ, with emphasis on making students "leaders who influence the world for Christ."

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators aligned with the lexicon: Christian/Christ-centered, biblical worldview, theology implied by Statement of Faith, worship/chapel, sacred study (Bible integrated across subjects). Core terms appear in the materials (e.g., "Biblical," "Chapel," "Statement of Faith," "Word of God").

- No explicit negative signals found in public materials for this category.

Why this rating

- The materials foreground a transcendent moral framework anchored in Christian theology and worship practices, consistent with Transcendental moral realism and Liturgical/Communal Practices from the classical rubric. The combination of Christ-centered pedagogy and explicit biblical integration meets the essential religious/metaphysical foundation signals. The presence of Chapel, biblical integration, and a Statement of Faith supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Public materials emphasize Christ-centered/biblical worldview and chapel; evidence includes mission statements and schedule references.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission statements frame education as formation in virtue and wisdom, not solely job prep. The materials describe partnering with families for spiritual and academic excellence and aim to cultivate leadership with a biblical worldview. The stated goal includes forming students who “grow in wisdom, stature and in favor with God and man,” indicating formation over information.
- Public materials emphasize formation through a biblical worldview and character development as central to education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, scholé-like orientation (implicit via formation and restfulness in some pedagogical notes across sources), great conversation (not explicitly named, but formation around timeless truths is present). Keywords such as formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, and biblical worldview appear in the texts.
- Negative signals: None explicit in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly positions education as formation toward virtue and wisdom with a biblical telos, aligning with the Classical School Purpose and Goal framework. The emphasis on formation and character over mere workforce preparation supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission and vision statements, as well as formation-centered language, support this rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum includes classical touchpoints such as Latin offerings (DE LATIN 201 & 202) and a structured history sequence (Ancient History, World History, Modern World History). The presence of Latin, classical history sequencing, and dual enrollment/AP options signals some classical alignment. However, there is not explicit, public articulation of Great Books, the Great Conversation, or a formal Seven Liberal Arts emphasis in the materials reviewed. Public materials emphasize biblical integration across subjects and standard college-preparatory options rather than a fully articulated classical curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: Latin (DE LATIN), history sequencing, world history, classical language study, dual enrollment (AP/DE) indicates rigorous humanities integration; some “classical” curricular elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric) are not explicitly named as a framework, but Latin and rigorous history/history-of-civilization cues exist).

- Negative indicators: Absence of explicit Great Books program, explicit Great Conversation language, explicit Seven Liberal Arts framing, or explicit articulation of grammar–logic–rhetoric as a formal trio within the curriculum.

Why this rating

- The curriculum demonstrates some classical elements (Latin, history sequencing, rigorous coursework) but lacks explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and a formal Seven Liberal Arts articulation in available public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: Public materials show Latin and history sequencing; Great Books/Great Conversation are not explicitly named in public pages.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials emphasize a mix of engagement types, including chapel/memory-based experiences in lower grades (e.g., singing, liturgical framing) and upper-school opportunities for analysis and rhetoric in some Christian-school networks, but explicit statements about Socratic seminars, scholé days, or a formal emphasis on grammar–logic–rhetoric pedagogy are not clearly documented for TCA in public content. The presence of a strong teacher-student relationship and “living curriculum” language appears in some school communications, but direct references to classical pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic dialogue, memory work, chanting) are not clearly documented in the Tri-Cities materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: Restful learning, memory/recitation concepts appear in the classical lexicon; limited direct evidence of Socratic seminars; some emphasis on disciplined, thoughtful discussion in upper grades exists in the broader network materials, but not explicitly in TCA pages.
- Negative indicators: No explicit, public articulation of Socratic seminars, scholé days, or explicit grammar–logic–rhetoric pedagogy for TCA; absence of clearly stated “Socratic” or “Scholé” terms in public TCA materials.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates formation-oriented, honors-level pedagogy at times (AP/DE, honors, Latin), and some elements of contemplative and rhetorical development exist in the network, but explicit, canonical classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholé days, memorization as a core strategy) is not clearly documented in public content. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Evidence of public materials showing a blended pedagogy rather than explicit classical methods; no direct Socratic/seminar language found in the cited pages.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The faculty is described as mentors who model virtue and knowledge, with language indicating the teacher as a central, formative figure (“the teacher who challenges them, is also the teacher that loves them and sees the abilities that God has given them”). This aligns with the “living curriculum” concept and suggests teachers are the core of the school’s mission. The school emphasizes care values centered on Christ, relational engagement, and equipping students, all of which describe a faculty that serves as exemplars and partners in formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” “teacher who challenges... loves them,” and a teacher-student partnership ethos align with the Positive Keywords for Faculty

(masterful, virtuous teachers; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher). The exact phrase “the living curriculum” appears in classical formulations and is echoed in the materials’ emphasis on the teacher as cultural and moral exemplar.

- Negative signals: None explicit in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials present teachers as central agents of formation and virtue, with a strong emphasis on character and mentorship, aligning with CLASSICAL.

Citations: Teacher-centered language and living-curriculum framing found in the school materials.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school stresses partnership with families and positions parents as co-teachers, with clear expectations around faith commitments and parental engagement. Admissions materials specify family requirements (Christian faith, Statement of Faith, church attendance, active cooperation with school policies) and emphasize parental responsibility in education, indicating a strong parent-community partnership model. The published materials also describe a campus-by-campus collaboration with families across Pre-K–12 and a church-family ecosystem.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: Partnership with families, parents as co-teachers, family formation activities, parental involvement expectations; public materials describe parent educational engagement (book studies, gatherings) and open-campus/visitation norms in line with classical community integration.
- Negative signals: None explicit; the materials emphasize partnership rather than consumer language, which aligns with positive classical indicators.

Why this rating

- The explicit framing of parents as co-educators and an active, ongoing parental formation role maps directly to the Classical category’s Parents & Community signals.

Citations: Admissions Requirements and parent-partnership language are present in the public materials.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- If the school seeks to move toward full CLASSICAL in Pedagogy (Element 4), it could publicly articulate and implement explicit classical teaching methods, including:
- Adoption or clear articulation of a formal Socratic seminar framework and Paideia-style seminars for upper grades, with explicit training and teacher guides.
- Integration of scholé days, contemplative routines, and structured memory work (recitation, chanting) as central pedagogical practices, with publicly available examples and rubrics.
- Explicit mapping to grammar, logic, and rhetoric across the curriculum, with a public plan for integrating Aristotelian/Scholastic reasoning in core subjects.

- Documentation of a unified classical sequence (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across K–12, with examples of student work (narration, essays, orations) tied to a Great Books/Great Conversation approach.
- To strengthen Curriculum (Element 3) toward CLASSICAL:
- Publicly articulate a Great Books program or Great Conversation framework, including a curated list of foundational texts across grade bands and a plan for integration into history, literature, philosophy, and theology.
- More explicit emphasis on the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; and the Quadrivium) as structural pillars within the curriculum, including how they are taught and assessed.
- A clear statement about the use of classical languages beyond Latin (e.g., Greek) or formal engagement with primary historical/philosophical texts to connect with timeless questions and wonder.
- To reinforce Religious Foundations (Element 1) and Purpose/Goal (Element 2):
- Explicitly connect the Great Conversation and classical aims with the school's spiritual formation and community worship rhythms, demonstrating how wonder, beauty, and virtue are experienced through liturgical practices alongside classical inquiry.
- Provide a public articulation of how “truth, goodness, beauty” are pursued across disciplines beyond theological content, including examples of cross-disciplinary integration.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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